

Task-2

Phishing Email Detection & Awareness Report

Target: Email-Based Phishing Attacks

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**Tools: Manual Analysis, Public Email
Samples**

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Introduction:

This report presents the analysis of phishing email samples to identify common attack patterns and security risks. The purpose of this assessment is to detect phishing indicators and provide recommendations to improve user awareness and prevent email-based attacks.

Scope:

- Analysis of sample phishing emails.
- Identification of phishing indicators.
- Classification of emails(Safe / Suspicious / Phishing)
- No active interaction with malicious links.

Tools Used:

- Public phishing email datasets.
- Manual content techniques.
- Browser inspection techniques.

Methodology:

- Collected phishing email samples.
- Analysis sender details ,subject ,and content.
- Identified suspicious elements such as spoofing and urgency.
- Classified emails based on risk level.

Email Analysis

1. Phishing Email

Objective:

Identify signs of phishing in account-related alert emails.

Findings(Observations):

- **Sender Name** : People's Bank
- **Greeting** : “Dear peoples Bank Client”
- **Request** : Request for sensitive information(ATM/Visa card number ,PIN , account details)
- **Tone** : Fear-based language (account locked)
- **Link** : Not provided

Phishing Indicators:

- Spoofed of fake sender addresses.
- Generic greetings (e.g., “Dear peoples Bank Client”)
- Urgent or threatening language.
- Requests for missing links
- Poor formatting or outdated templates.

Phishing Techniques Explained:

- **Spoofing** : Attackers impersonate trusted organizations.
- **Social Engineering** :Manipulating users emotionally(fear)
- **Information Harvesting** : Collecting sensitive user data.

Result:

Phishing Email

2. Phishing Email

Objective:

Analyze transaction-based phishing email.

Findings(Observations):

- **Sender** : People's Bank
- **Subject** : EFT Activity Notification message
- **Content** : Payment processing message
- **Action** : Login to verify payment
- **Link** : Removed (suspicious)
- **Tone** : informational but slightly urgent

Phishing Indicators:

- Unexpected Transaction Alert
- Call to Action (Login Request)
- Link Not Clearly Provided
- Generic Notification

Phishing Techniques Explained:

- **Pretexting** : Attackers create fake payment scenario to appear legitimate.
- **Social Engineering** : Creates confusion and urgency to force quick action.
- **Credential Harvesting** : Tricks users into entering login details.
- **Impersonation** : Pretends to be a trusted bank.

Result:

Suspicious Email

3. Phishing Email

Objective:

Analyze security update phishing attempt

Findings(Observations):

- **Sender** : “Peoples bank” (quoted - suspicious formatting)
- **Subject** : Official information
- **Greeting** : Generic
- **Content** : Talks about browser vulnerabilities
- **Action Requested** : Login to verify/update
- **Link** : Removed

Phishing Indicators:

- Generic Greeting
- Fake Technical Explanation
- Login Request via Link
- Unusual Formatting

Phishing Techniques Explained:

- **Authority-Based Phishing** : Uses official-looking message to gain trust.
- **Technical Deception** : Mentions fake security updates to confuse users.
- **Social Engineering** : Builds trust using formal language.
- **Credential Harvesting** : Reflects users to fake login page.

Result:

Phishing Email

Coclusion

The phishing email analysis identified multiple malicious patterns, primarily involving social engineering, spoofed domains, and credential harvesting attempts. These attacks exploit user trust and urgency to gain unauthorized access. Implementing awareness practices and security controls can significantly reduce the risk of phishing attacks.